

SELF-LIKING, CONDITION FOR UNIVERSAL STATE OF BLISS

Greetings, my dearest friends. Blessings for everyone of you here present and all my friends who are working on this path of self-realization and liberation. There is much progress in many of you, and what I will say is, for many of you, perhaps the very thing you need most to hear at this time -- if you hear with your inner ear as much as with your outer ear.

The entire universe is constituted in such a way that each created individual is capable of being in a constant state of bliss. Each created individual is made in such a way that this is not only a theoretical possibility, but it is man's natural state of being. It is the natural law. When an individual is not in a state of bliss, it is an unnatural, disturbed condition. It is exceedingly important for you, my friends, to really grasp and appreciate this fact.

When I speak of a state of bliss, I do not mean this for a vague future -- a future either in this life or for a future in a life beyond the physical state of existence. It is indeed possible right here and right now. Nor does this depend on some complicated feat, on a difficult state of perfection foreign to your present way of being. It does not depend on outer events or indeed on anything having to be different from what it is right in this minute. Man is prone to think that if only this or that were different (within or around him), then nothing would stand in the way of his happiness. Total happiness is possible immediately, as you are now.

Man's search is always directed in a wrong way. He makes it too complicated in that he assumes he, or circumstances, would have to change before he can attain fulfillment and a state of pleasure supreme as his normal, natural climate. In tonight's lecture, I would like to speak about the condition that makes it possible to be in a state of bliss right now.

Man unconsciously knows that a state of pleasure supreme is his birthright, and he constantly strives for it, whether he realizes this or not. That this striving goes in a wrong direction, as just mentioned, does not alter the fact as such. Once man learns to search in the proper direction, he will find what he seeks. There are two aspects I shall discuss in this connection.

The state man consciously or unconsciously seeks depends directly on his self-liking, his self-esteem. The equation always comes out even. To the exact degree self-liking exists, to that degree happiness exists. Lack of self-liking prevents the psyche from experiencing its natural state. It induces an alienation from the universal forces and sets up a screen, or a film, preventing the individual from becoming part of the cosmic forces, which are bliss. It does not matter whether the lack of self-liking is based on realistic or unrealistic reasons. Both present an equal obstacle. This is why a reevaluation of one's concepts is part of the process of self-realization since often man dislikes himself for the wrong reasons. I pointed out before that a balance exists and that a fine inner mechanism regulates the psychic processes whereby justified reasons for self-dislike, when not

consciously recognized and come to terms with, create false guilts and exaggerated standards of perfection. In the last analysis, it is therefore always a question of a violation of personal integrity which prevents the personality from coming into his own -- whether or not it also causes false guilts.

This inner mechanism is very exciting, and no self-deception or conscious ignorance of it can eliminate the effects of self-dislike. The most enlightened human beings still ignore the importance and significance of this fact. In our past work together, we discussed many aspects of what causes an impairment of integrity and therefore of self-respect. Any path of self-realization must deal with the most subtle, unconscious soul movements and attitudes because their effect is so much greater than most individuals only remotely sense.

One such aspect is being true to the natural laws existing in life and the individual as opposed to allegiance to handed down values, to superimposed standards, to the mores of any given society or culture. We discussed this topic before, but not quite in this particular connection. Self-realization and liberation are very much determined by the freedom of an individual to adopt natural, universal laws and standards, by making his own independent decision to adopt them with his reasoning process, and by taking the responsibility for this decision fully upon himself. Such a state of mind differs drastically from the one in which a human being automatically adopts views, opinions, apparent laws of life, standards of ethics and morals without questioning their sense, their inevitability, and their reason. The automatism in which most people take conditions and laws of life for granted prevents autonomy of self. This automatism is far more widespread and affects many more areas of life and personality than you can imagine, my friends. We discussed the effects of mass images, mass impressions, before. But most of you think of the crass issues in this connection, the issues that most developed people begin to question and wonder about. None of you are aware that there still exist issues within you which would require a new and fresh approach. Taking a law or a standard for granted that is not a law of universal life, you close the door to the universe.

Often the most rebellious human beings are most impregnated with mass opinions and false limitations as inevitable laws of life. They would not rebel against life if they would not believe that they have to bow down to something inevitable. Often it is not even a question of a difference between the natural laws and the mores of a civilization. Although such differences are frequently quite pronounced (and it is tragic how much waste and unnecessary hardship exist due to allegiance to unnatural laws), sometimes the natural and unnatural laws are similar or apparently identical. Yet it makes a world of difference whether one abides by standards of conscience in the free spirit of self-choice, or acts in blind obedience and unquestioning lack of consciousness. The words may ring similar, but the flavor of psychic processes, of inner climate and attitude, is totally different. When the natural law is different from the manmade one, the difference becomes even more obvious.

When man denies himself the fresh and spontaneous experience of coming to self-found and independent, self-responsible concepts according to which he conducts his life, he is not acting from mere laziness. Why does such laziness exist? It is not even simply fear. In the last analysis, it is always a violation of integrity. As long as man views this factor with the idea that fear prevents him from this self-responsible inner conduct, the fear will not vanish. When he begins to see that his integrity is affected by his refusal to seek his own answers, an innate decency and desire to be

truthful often gives the incentive that is lacking as long as man ignores these deeper issues of personal integrity.

Now, why is integrity damaged when an individual refuses to come to autonomous answers about life's rules, life's apparent restrictions and limitations? There is always cowardice at stake when a person blindly takes rules and laws for granted and inevitable. It is lack of courage that induces an individual to repeat handed down moral codes rather than questioning with his own deep, sincere, and honest reasoning processes. He accepts many handed down laws because he is afraid of the consequences, afraid that the opinion of others may be different, and that he thus will get into conflict with other people's opinion of him. When these motivations are honestly examined and faced, one cannot help but see that simple opportunism -- on an emotional level -- plays a dominant role. He sells out on a truth he shies away from naming in order to obtain approval or even admiration from others. The freeing of the real self is impossible as long as such conditions prevail in the psyche. Wherever ready-made opinions are echoed (whether the person is aware of this fact or not), a violation of personal integrity, an opportunism of some sort, must exist. It is important to note here that this does not necessarily mean a majority opinion. It may apply as much to a rebellious opinion of a minority group. There, too, a blind, unquestioning, emotionally colored motivation may contain cowardice and opportunism even though outwardly it seems courageous to defy the rest of the world.

The laziness of thinking through is never just laziness per se. It always contains the cowardly opportunities to comply with special surroundings the individual believes he desperately needs and cannot afford to antagonize. There is a special temptation that strengthens the tendency to forsake self-responsible questioning and independent concepts formed according to the natural laws of life. This temptation is that all the world pronounces the mores of society as good and righteous, while the love of the natural laws is often ignored. Hence, the man who follows the manmade law receives homage for his goodness and righteousness. This is not only tempting from the point of view of needing the approval of others, it appears like medicine to the sores of self-doubt and self-dislike. But the medicine only removes the pangs of the pain, which is but the symptom, never the root of the problem. When the real reasons for self-dislike are removed, the courage to be a self grows in proportion. Many times the real reason for self-dislike is at least in part the very cowardice to sell out on the truth for the convenience of being approved of by others. So, the so-called medicine and the poison are frequently the same.

When it happens that a person begins to crystallize the very questions he is to ask, to challenge, to probe deeper, and to come into his own, then to take outer action in accordance with the answers that may come is not even of primary importance. What is of primary importance is knowing. Let us suppose that the consequent actions are still difficult to follow through because not enough courage could have grown yet. At least the individual is in a state of truth about himself rather than in the self-deception and lack of awareness that had existed before. He is thus nearer himself and nearer the universal truth that is all bliss and all fulfillment.

Knowing the natural law of evolution (even when not being able to live by it yet) creates a freedom and truthfulness as an inner climate. The knowing is therefore primary. It immediately affects man's state of pleasure, of joyfulness, when he is in truth in this regard. For he must respect and like himself to the degree he no longer glosses over and takes for granted those apparently

unquestionable, "self-understood" aspects of life. If he knows, self-liking is established, and with self-liking, the capacity to partake in the universal blissfulness, which is a natural fact.

The second aspect I want to discuss is transcending the now. No matter where you are, my friends; no matter what your present condition or circumstances are; no matter how you feel, if this now is thoroughly faced, not run away from, it yields a wealth of beautiful energy, life substance, joyfulness. You can find in this now exhilaration and bliss, peace and stimulation, a deep sense of purpose that will lend meaning to all you do -- inwardly and outwardly. Pleasure supreme lies in every fraction of life, provided you do not escape from it, push away from it -- perhaps by pushing at yourself to be what you are not at this moment. No matter what the mood of the moment may be, if you are self-alienated, if you feel disconnected, if you feel anxious or depressed or hopeless or bored, there is in this very moment, through this mood, your nucleus, your now. And if you face this now, if you look at and are in this mood and transcend it, you do not have to wait for a far future nor even for a different state of being, a state of perfection. You then must be in the life force and life substance of your immediate now and therefore in bliss. You are then in a moving stream of growth, of evolution. You then cannot help but like yourself on a deep and subtle level, a level usually covered up. It seems often the most difficult thing for man to do, and yet it is the easiest to do.

No matter how many times you may have heard such words, in different connections or contexts, the habit force is deeply indoctrinated on both these counts: on the count of taking things for granted without questioning them and on the count of running away from your immediate mood so that you are not in contact with yourself. Both aspects are essential for being in the live-center of your real self, where all good exists in immeasurable power, forever and ever. This power waits to be utilized until you wake up to its reality. Deep in this center of yourself, that can be reached by the road I show you, exists this power and a presence of all wisdom which is constantly available. In this center, life eternal manifests right now.

Anyone of my good friends would be surprised if he were to see a list showing how many things he or she still takes for granted and how he blindly accepts many laws and precepts as inevitable, that are by no means natural. So, my friends, examine yourself from this point of view. You will oust many unnecessary ideas and supposed inevitables. You will subsequently also find the courage to pay allegiance to natural laws that you discover for yourself through an honest and fresh approach. A new integrity will be born in you and also the courage to dispense with appeasement, with conformity in whatever shape it may exist.

The need to be like others is not opposite to the need to be special and better than others. They are two sides of the same coin of duality. To the extent man conforms, takes for granted what others have told him (explicitly as well as implicitly), he believes in laws that are not natural laws and in facts that are not inevitable facts; to that extent he is also compelled to prove his specialness and to set himself up with pride. The cowardice to conform is the same as the pride to be better. Both can be shed only when the courage exists to question apparent inevitables and when the humility exists not to have to be better. That is the freedom that opens the gate to the universe. And it opens the gate to the real self.

Now when this courage and this humility exist, it is easy to question oneself at this moment what one feels, where one is, why one reacts in the way one does, why the reaction exists in the first

place instead of leaving all this in a vague foggy climate. It is this fog that alienates you from the live-center of being in pleasure, of being in a meaningful state of exhilaration, of wisdom, of all eternal good and unceasing life. The fog of vagueness of not looking at the pride and the cowardice prevents you from reaching this life. Therefore each moment can be owned up to only when courage and humility exist -- the courage to question the handed down codes, the courage to look at every and any truth within the self, and the humility not to have to be special, and perhaps, if necessary, for the sake of truth, to dispense with approval by others.

My friends, each moment offers a richness, a perfection, a fullness no matter where you are, no matter what is your particular predicament. And when you find yourself saying, "Yes, I am now in this or that unfortunate state," discover further that perhaps in ever so subtle a manner, you are in a state of waiting, or even pressure, to reach a different state. You cannot grow when you strive away from what you are now. This striving is an error, a misunderstanding. It is based on denial of what is. When the present state is fully seen, admitted, and understood, pride and cowardice can simply be dropped in an effortless way.

Is not cowardice, with all its compliance and conformity, its self-negation and denial of truth, its opportunism and betrayal of cosmic reality, a result of pride? Does it not require humility to dispense with the need to have the approval of others? This courage can only be attained when humility exists. You will not sell out, violate, and betray your real self when you can let go of admiration, of being singled out in some way.

Now, my friends, are there any questions?

QUESTION: You speak about the people who want to be better than others, who want to be special. But how about those who feel that they are not as good as others?

ANSWER: It is the same. It is again the duality, two sides of the same coin. No one who feels genuinely his value ever needs to prove himself better than others. It is only those who doubt their value. This is why I began this lecture by saying that self-liking is the key to a state of bliss. Here lies the vicious circle. The more he sells out, the less man likes himself, the greater his need to receive approval by others to assuage his self-doubts. The greater his attempt to have others give him what he himself can effectively supply, the more he is driven to betray the truth of the universe and the truth in himself.

One can only get out of such a vicious circle by working on a path of self-finding. Each moment of discontent contains answers for you. If you look for these answers, you transcend the now and experience the truth of the universe, which is that every fraction of life is infinite bliss.

QUESTION: I ask for someone else, whom I want to help...

ANSWER: When it concerns these levels, one cannot help others except by showing them a way, provided they are willing. But this willingness must exist in everyone, for, otherwise, real help is quite impossible. Unfortunately, most people would rather do anything, go anywhere, than look at the self. Most people are frightened of this and frantically try to avoid it. When an entity is ready to look where the looking will yield real answers, help must come. There is no other way, and this applies equally to all human beings. No one can help another person to being in the now, for this

presupposes the absolute and primary desire, "I want to look at the truth in myself." Anyone in this pathwork who pronounces to himself these words every day, again and again and particularly at moments when he feels discontented and disconnected, will experience amazing results. "What is it now that I do not want to look at?" When an individual does this, answers will come forth -- absolutely and inevitably -- in exact proportion to the sincerity and strength of this wish. Otherwise, there is no answer, my friends. This applies to those who have not even begun yet to discover that depths exist in the self that badly need to be explored and raised to the light of consciousness. It also applies to those who are effectively engaged in such pathwork. For they too may have blind spots where they persist in overlooking what needs most to be faced, while they overconcentrate on other aspects that may be important in themselves, but which have already been faced and are overemphasized just because this latter truth lends itself well to cover up other truths the person is not ready to see. They too no matter how much growth actually exists, go through moments of the day which they do not utilize to the fullest, which they overlook and let stand unexamined, remaining on the outer cover and layers, never reaching the nucleus of the disturbance. Here, too, the disturbance may be accepted in a false spirit of inevitability, of taking for granted what need not be. They too may rationalize aspects of their life and thus aspects of themselves.

Each moment contains a wealth, my friends, a wealth that is indescribable. Your human mind lacks the equipment at this point to even remotely conceive it. Perhaps it can be compared with the theory of atoms, or better, the science of atoms. It has shown man that the smallest particles, too small to measure with the eye, contain such power that vast areas of human habitation and millions of human lives can be destroyed by this power. But this very same power also contains the possibility to affect human life positively in equal measure to its destructiveness. It is man's mental attitude that determines the direction this power goes. But whether this power is used constructively or destructively, the human race begins to be aware of the power of the smallest fractions of measurement -- a concept new and strange for human thinking since heretofore man's thinking was geared to size. In other words, big things can yield great power, small things have little power. With the science of atoms, a revolutionary reorientation has begun, forcing man into recognizing that power is not a matter of size but rather a matter of quality. With this new concept, the truth of a new dimension begins to open up.

It is exactly the same with the now of each moment. Each fraction of "time," of existence, of life contains a power and wealth that by far surpasses in scope, depth, and potential the power of the atom. For it is a spiritual power, and as such, it supersedes all physical manifestations, including atomic power. If the fraction of life is known to contain such power and is utilized by examining its negative manifestation, the inherent nucleus of power can then be used positively. Man is utterly oblivious, as yet, of this fact. He assigns power to all other circumstances and factors, but not to the very now. He overlooks the truth that each now contains immeasurable life force, which can be freed when the obstructions of the now are met. All you need to do is focus your attention on it. Then you will discover riches and powers still inconceivable in their fullness; but the first inklings will already astound you. You do not have to wait for tomorrow. You do not even have to wait for a different state of existence. The desired tomorrow, or the desired different state of existence, will come as a result of meeting this moment in truth. If you wish to look at yourself in the truth of this moment, if you give this your full integrity and honesty and attention, the moment will yield the powers contained in you and offer it for your life.

QUESTION: The expression of "seeing yourself in truth" seems to have lost its meaning because a lot of people use this expression and claim that they see themselves in truth, yet I know they are not. An expression is often used in such a way that it loses its real meaning. Could you clarify this regarding "seeing oneself in truth?" Don't you mean by this that it applies to areas where people don't want to face the truth about themselves? Perhaps you can say it in a different way?

ANSWER: This is, unfortunately, the fate of all truth in the human realm, not even due to the limitation of expressing spiritual truth in language. Rather, language can lend itself well to conceal and displace, to deceive the self by using the same words while avoiding the real issues where these words would be most applicable. There are no specific expressions in any language that can guarantee to avoid such subterfuges and more or less subtle self-deceptions. Only the utter and thorough inner will, the profound sincerity to be truthful with the self, can avoid this. Man's tendency to run away from himself makes him use language in an ambiguous way. He says the word "truth" and applies it perhaps to general factors, where he is indeed saying a truth. But he avoids a truth about himself by doing so. This is how a truth becomes just a word and eventually a cliché. This is precisely the reason why I restate and reformulate in different words the same truths.

All I can add here is that man cannot be in the universal, general truth, the dynamic truth of life, unless he is in the truth of himself. Not only in those truths he has already faced, but also with regard to those factors that are still difficult to look at. As long as he refuses to face what seems most difficult, he is not in a truthful state. There are always areas one has less resistance to look at. These may offer an opportunity to deceive oneself as to the areas where one is still unwilling to see himself unmasked.

It is essential that man say to himself -- again and again and again -- "I want to look at everything, I want to see even that where I am most resistant." Then and then only can he fulfill himself. Then and then only can all the difficulties, all the apparently insurmountable obstructions dissolve and things fall naturally and effortlessly into their proper place and order so that a nonwasteful, meaningful life establishes itself. The universal stream of life brings harmony where disharmony existed, brings meaning where waste existed, brings fulfillment where frustration existed, brings pleasure supreme where pain and deprivation existed. But the courage and humility to be in total truth about the self must be cultivated and summoned -- daily, as it were, not paying lip service to it, but really meaning it. "I am not afraid to look, whatever it is that I do not want to see. I request the divine wisdom and power within me to make me see where I do not want to see so that I can change where this is indicated." This must be followed through consistently in order to attain total liberation of all unnecessary shackles that encase the real self, to attain the blissful truth of the universe.

QUESTION: I want to ask about a strange and frightening experience I had lately. When I feel particularly liberated after certain clarifications and I then register a surging feeling of the life force in me, during meditation I have the impression as though my genitals would be lifted off me. I feel a new hope, but at the same time there is fear contained in this hope. What can you tell me about this?

ANSWER: This experience is an expression of greater progress than you can perhaps appreciate at this moment. As a result of much understanding and truth you have gained and also as a result of certain change in your inner being, you have released life power that was hitherto

paralyzed. This induces the hope where before you have felt hopeless that you might ever experience aliveness and pleasure and exhilaration. At the same time, all this has brought into the open a misconception lodged deeply in your psyche, that if you give vent to the live energy in your body, you might be endangered, particularly by the loss of your genitals. This misconception is frequent, but this does not alter the fact that it is a real threat to you. Until now, you were not conscious of it. Your outer reasoning made it impossible to admit such a preposterous alternative. Nevertheless, the child in you is governed by this proposition, and it is responsible for many of your difficulties. Finding out the living reality of this misconception -- not as a psychological theory, but as a personal conviction -- will eventually enable you to realize that it is a false idea. When you fear the hope that opens up to you, it is because you still believe in the truth of the threat so that the hope of new life at the same time contains the danger presented by your misconception. Your conflict seems to be: "Should I stay the way I am and be dead, have no meaningful life, and become lonelier and more separated from all meaning and exhilaration; or shall I take the step and perhaps perish?" This is the state in which you now inwardly find yourself. This can only be resolved when you truly understand that the misconception is a misconception. The pain will vanish, for the pain is a result of the misconception and of the ensuing conflict.

QUESTION: As to living in the now and seeing what is there, I discovered that there is always a slight feeling of a need for reassurance. This made me aware that I am hardly ever living in an unself-conscious way. Everything is always geared to obtaining this reassurance. I live in order to be what I'd like to be, and not to be what I am. Can you help me with that?

ANSWER: The vicious circle I discussed in this lecture prevails. Your need for reassurance is based on the doubt that you sufficiently count, that your own intrinsic values are sufficient onto you. You fear that your own conscience, your own opinions are not valid so that you need a confirmation or reassurance by others. Any unreal needs have an addictive quality; the more one needs them, the stronger the unhealthy striving becomes, and the further one gets away from the inner source of all solutions. Also, the more one gets used to it, the more one thinks one needs it. When you go into the moment and discover this to be your present condition, the next step would have to be to ask yourself what particular reassurance you want. Once you put this into words, you can then ask yourself where you are unsure of the issue involved. Your personal truth must be brought out as to the underlying uncertainty. Then and only then will you find that a fearful opportunism exists in specific areas where you shy away from your truth in relation to universal truth. This fearful opportunism may easily be covered up by apparent rebellion.

This discovery is already the first layer of the moment. Knowing about this need enables you to go to the next layer, which is exploring your doubt that makes the reassurance apparently necessary. Where do you perhaps forsake a natural law and do not even wish to know it so as not to endanger yourself and come into opposition with what you fear the world expects of you? Do you understand?

QUESTION: Yes, I think I understand it quite well. Now, supposing the answer is that my doubts and need for reassurance concern my masculinity. How does this apply to what you said about the natural law as opposed to complying with the expectations of my surroundings?

ANSWER: You forsake the natural law by not trusting in the benign nature of your feelings. You cut them off. There is deep in you a mechanism that says, "No, I will go no further. I let

myself go that far because that is pleasurable, but I will not go to the risk of allowing my full nature to take its course." You do this partly because of the world, because you fear censure, and partly because of a misconception similar to what our friend who asked the last question has discovered. The fear is surely not as strong as it exists with him, but you nevertheless also feel threatened by the natural feelings in you and pay allegiance to the world which proclaims that one should not trust these feelings. Thus you deny the universal forces within you and want to play it "safe."

Think deeply about all this my friends, and try to apply it to yourselves. Approach yourselves with courage and humility, and something will open up in you. A fountain and wealth of wonderful strength, the love and wisdom of the universe will become available for you. Be blessed, my dearest ones, feel the love and the truth as they are always here. Be in peace, be in God!

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